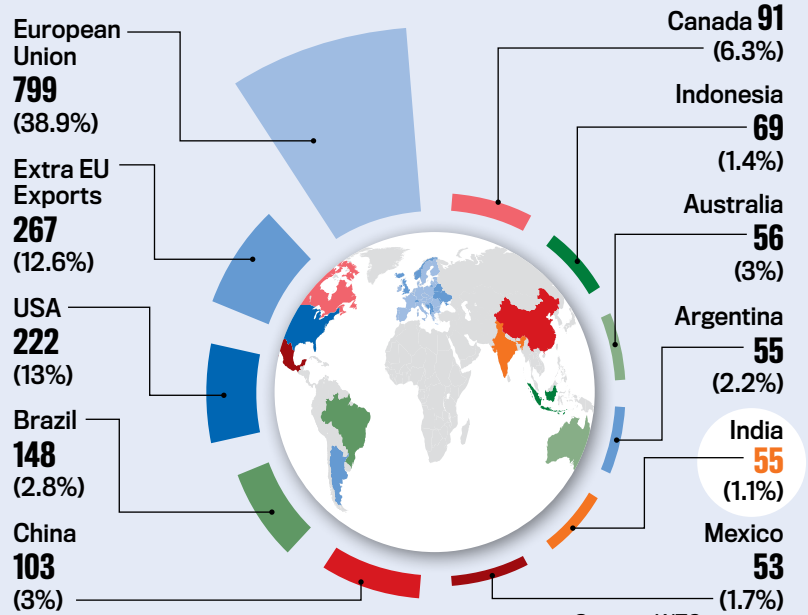
REACHING FOR THE HIGH-HANGING FRUIT

India is among the top 10 exporters of agri produce, horticulture could help it hit the top tier

TOP 10 EXPORTERS OF AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTS

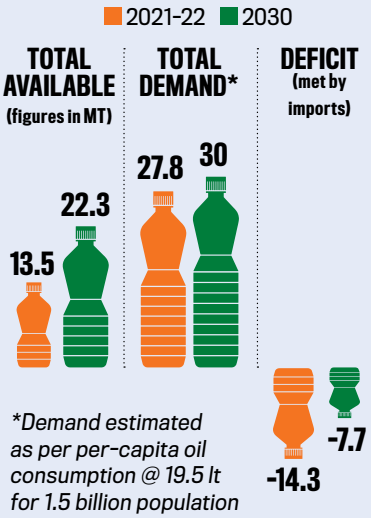
Value in $ bn and %age of world share



Source: WTO

SLIPPERY SLOPE

Edible oil production has not kept up with demand, but the gap is narrowing



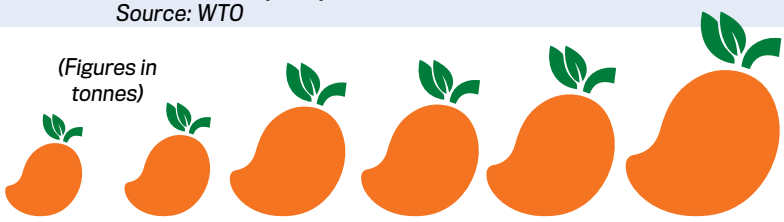
**Demand estimated as per per-capita oil consumption @ 19.5 lt for 1.5 billion population*

AT AAM'S LENGTH

Exports of four tropical fruits— mango, pineapple, avocado and papaya—are growing globally. India has significant exports only in the king of fruits, mango, where it is No. 5 in the world

Source: Major Tropical Fruits Market Review, 2023, FAO

(Figures in tonnes)



Pakistan	India	Peru	Brazil	Thailand	Mexico
123,617	145,499	266,045	275,818	341,418	482,640

production challenges (they can't scale up), along with lack of proper irrigation and poor soil management. Limited land availability also affects crop rotation and the use of sustainable agricultural practices, as small farmers may not have the space or the wherewithal to implement these successfully. Therefore, smallholders will have to be formed into groups and recommended specific crops in order to create an advantage. Inadequate availability of quality planting material is also a factor for the low productivity of various horticulture crops, according to the National Horticultural Board. That said, precision farming methods, including the latest agronomic knowledge and sustainable farming techniques, integrated pest management, and responsible use of crop protection products, can boost yields and maintain quality while minimising environmental impact.

The limited reach of farm insurance and farm mechanisation, combined with a lack of access to institutional credit for small and marginal farmers, currently contribute to lower investment in the sector. To ensure the flow of adequate credit, the government sets annual targets for it. But even so, nearly 30 per cent of agricultural households still avail credit from non-institutional sources, according to the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD).

IF THE AREA UNDER HORTICULTURE CULTIVATION GOES UP BY 50 PER CENT, IT ALONE COULD DELIVER ON THE MUCH PROMISED DOUBLING OF FARMERS' INCOMES